

INTERNATIONAL news

Trump's tariff plan could derange electronics supply chain globally

US President-elect Donald Trump proposed tariff hikes on Chinese imports, which could significantly increase the prices of electronics like smartphones, laptops, and tablets. Experts warn that tariffs up to 100% could raise smartphone prices by 26% and laptops by 46%, disrupting global semiconductor supply chains and leading to higher consumer costs in the United States.

US releases new export restrictions on Chinese chip firms

The US has imposed new export restrictions on 140 Chinese companies, including chip tool manufacturers, to hinder China's semiconductor and AI advancements, particularly for military use. The expanded Foreign Direct Product (FDP) rule now includes chipmaking equipment from Malaysia, Singapore, Israel, Taiwan, and South Korea while exempting the Netherlands and Japan.

South Korea plans \$10 billion loan for semiconductor sector

South Korean government plans to provide 14 trillion won (\$10 billion) in low-interest loans next year to support its semiconductor industry amid growing competition from China and uncertainties under the new US administration. The funds, allocated through state-owned banks, will support chip manufacturing complexes, including power transmission lines for a new hub in Yongin and Pyeongtaek.

German government plans \$2 billion boost for chip industry

Germany plans to allocate up to 2 billion euros in subsidies to support its semiconductor industry, aiming to enhance manufacturing capacity and Europe's competitiveness. The funding, aligned with the European Chips Act, will help modernise facilities beyond current standards. The initiative encourages local chip production to reduce reliance on Asian suppliers.

Intel secures \$7.9 billion fund from the White House

The Biden administration has finalised Intel's funding through the CHIPS Act, reducing the original award to \$7.86 billion. The funding supports semiconductor projects in Arizona, New Mexico, Ohio, and Oregon, including a \$3 billion contract for the US Department of Defence. Intel aims to invest \$100 billion in the US, creating over 10,000 jobs.

US sanctions \$6.2 billion to Micron for memory chip advancement

The US government has allocated nearly \$6.2 billion for Micron Technology under the CHIPS Act. This funding supports Micron's \$100 billion investment in New York and \$25 billion in Idaho, creating 20,000 jobs and boosting US memory chip manufacturing. The initiative aims to reduce reliance on foreign sources and strengthen national security.

Google partners with Intersect and TPG to develop energy parks for new energy centres

Google has partnered with Intersect Power and TPG Rise Climate, investing \$800 million to develop energy parks for new data centres. The project, planned for completion by 2027, has a planned \$20 billion in renewable energy and storage. Google will buy power from these assets to enhance sustainability while navigating regulatory challenges in energy integration.

TotalEnergies to acquire VSB Group for \$2.1 billion

TotalEnergies is set to acquire VSB Group for \$2.1 billion, expanding its renewable energy portfolio in Europe. VSB, a pan-European firm specialising in wind and solar projects, will help TotalEnergies strengthen its sustainability goals. This move follows TotalEnergies' decision to pause investments in Adani Group amid ongoing investigations.

NXP-Vanguard joint venture starts construction of \$7.8 billion fab in Singapore

VisionPower Semiconductor Manufacturing Company (VSMC), a joint venture between Vanguard International and NXP Semiconductors, has begun construction of a \$7.8 billion wafer manufacturing facility in Singapore. Expected to start production in 2027, the plant will produce 55,000 300mm wafers monthly by 2029, create 1500 jobs, and emphasise sustainability with energy-efficient design.

US approves \$1.5 billion subsidy for GlobalFoundries expansion

The US Commerce Department has finalised a \$1.5 billion subsidy for GlobalFoundries to expand semiconductor production in Malta, New York, and Vermont. This expansion supports industries like automotive, IoT, and aerospace. GlobalFoundries' \$13 billion investment will enhance US chip production over the next decade, with state and federal funding totalling \$2.05 billion.

Vishay invests £51 million in Newport fab, boosting UK chip sector

Vishay Intertechnology is set to bet £51 million into the Newport wafer fab in Wales, which it purchased for £142 million in 2023. This funding will establish power and silicon carbide (SiC) device production lines. Supported by a £5 million Welsh government contribution, the investment strengthens Wales' semiconductor sector and secures nearly 400 jobs.

Denso and Fuji Electric collaborate on \$1.4 billion semiconductor project

Denso and Fuji Electric are investing \$1.4 billion to produce silicon carbide (SiC) power semiconductors for electric vehicles (EVs), with support from Japan's Ministry of Economy, Trade, and Industry. The project, expected to be completed by 2027, will enhance Japan's semiconductor supply chain and boost global competitiveness in the EV sector.

ESA funds Euro 34.6 million for Open Cosmos' satellite mission

The European Space Agency (ESA) has awarded Euro 34.6 million to Open Cosmos for its NanoMagSat mission, which will launch three satellites in 2026 to study Earth's magnetic field and ionosphere. The 24kg satellites will gather data on space weather, impacting global communications and navigation, over three years.

Space tech startup Akash secures \$68 million CHIPS funding

Akash Systems, a satellite tech startup, has secured up to \$18.2 million in CHIPS Act funding from the US Commerce Department. The company will receive \$68 million in federal and state support to expand semiconductor manufacturing, focusing on advanced cooling technology. The project will create 400+ jobs and enhance AI chip performance.